THE POWER OF TAHAJJUD

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REAL STORIES OF SUCCESS AND MIRACLES

JAWWAD ABBASI

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The Power of Tahajjud

Real Stories of Success and Miracles

Jawwad Ahmed Abbasi

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DEDICATION

To my mother and my brother

who always encouraged me to do more,

and believed in me more than I ever believed in myself.

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I am deeply grateful to everyone who shared their stories. Your honesty, courage, and openness have made this book possible, and your voices shine through every page.

To my family, for the countless ways you have lifted me, guided me, and stood by me—your presence has been my strength and my greatest blessing.

And to you, the reader, may Allah place barakah in every page you turn, and may He grant you moments of closeness with Him when the world is quiet, and your heart is most in need. May your duas be heard, answered, and unfold in ways more beautiful than you could ever imagine.

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PREFACE

For many years, I have volunteered with various MSAs, masajid, and Islamic institutes. During that time, I have met people from all kinds of backgrounds, each carrying their own struggles. In private conversations, they would open up about school, work, family, health, and moments when life felt overwhelming. Often, they didn't realize that one of the most powerful solutions to their challenges could be found in Tahajjud, the night prayer.

This book shares success stories of ordinary people who turned to Allah at night, praying for a new job, better health, love, success in exams, or the ability to start and nurture a family. Through these prayers, they achieved outcomes that often seemed miraculous: recovering from long-term illness, finding a life partner after years of searching, overcoming financial hardships that nearly broke them, or finally starting a family after repeated challenges.

These stories reveal a simple but powerful truth: Tahajjud is not just for the exceptionally pious. It is a hidden gem in every believer's arsenal, accessible to all, often overlooked, and capable of transforming any struggle while strengthening our connection with Allah.

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By reading these stories, you can see the power of Tahajjud in action. Ordinary people have used it to seek Allah's help, guidance, and relief in their daily struggles, and you can unlock the same power for yourself. Turning to Allah at night can bring blessings, solutions, and a deeper connection with Him that we all seek.

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NOTE ON THE STORIES

While the stories in this book are based on real experiences, some details, such as names, locations, and timelines, have been changed for privacy.

In some cases, the author has expanded or dramatized events to better convey the emotional journey.

The lessons, struggles, and moments of connection remain true to what happened, even if the narrative has been adjusted to help you feel the depth of the experience.

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Chapter One
Illusion of Control

Life rarely goes as we imagine. We make plans, work hard, and try to prepare for every outcome, yet there are moments when events slip beyond our control. It can feel frustrating, helpless, and even frightening. We all have areas in our lives where control seems just out of reach—circumstances that no amount of effort or preparation can fully manage.

In this chapter, we examine that reality through different experiences. One story follows a husband as he navigates profound challenges in his family life, confronting situations he cannot change, no matter how much he wishes he could. The other tells of a man imprisoned, physically

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confined and at the mercy of decisions far beyond his control. Both journeys show that life can push us to limits we never expected, testing our patience, resilience, and faith.

These stories reveal a key truth: control is often just an illusion. We might feel trapped by circumstances, burdened by uncertainty, or even powerless when outcomes depend on others or on external factors. Still, even in those moments, there is a chance to grow, to strengthen our hearts, and to deepen our connection with Allah, especially through Tahajjud.

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Please, God…
Don't Take Her Away

I used to be a Christian, but alhamdulillah, I found my way to Islam through reading the Quran and watching lectures online. That's how everything started shifting for me—reading verses that touched my soul, listening to scholars explain the beauty of the religion. But right in the middle of all that, my wife got sick. It wasn't just any illness; it was a complete mess of medical issues that the doctors struggled to identify. We married out of love, old friends who knew each other's hearts inside out, both Christians at the time. Our daughter was born, this little mirror of her mum, with the same bright eyes and that laugh that could light up a room.

Life moved quickly. I had our daughter to care for—she was still so young—the job that paid the bills, and the house that needed managing. When my wife's condition worsened, they quickly admitted her to the

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hospital. I dropped our daughter off at her grandmother's every morning, then went straight to the hospital to stay in that cramped guest room by her side. Nights blurred into days with no real sleep, just me staring at the ceiling or watching her breathe. Each morning, I forced myself to go to the office, putting on a fake smile for my colleagues while my body begged for rest. My health suffered—dark circles deep under my eyes, and I felt like I was running on empty.

One afternoon, the doctor pulled me aside in the hallway, his face serious as he laid it out: "Your wife doesn't have much time left." Those words hit me hard like a truck. I stumbled back to the room, kept it together until she drifted off to sleep, then I fell apart. Tears rolled down my face as I held her hand, my chest heaving with sobs, I tried to stifle into the pillow. I loved her so deeply—years of shared dreams, inside jokes, that intimate understanding we had. And our daughter, looking just like her, made the pain even sharper. How could I face all this alone? The responsibilities weighed me down: providing for our girl, keeping the home in order, and holding down my job. It felt like the world was collapsing around me.

I couldn't bring myself to tell her the truth right away. Instead, I told her the doctor had cleared her to go home, that she was on the mend. Her face lit up with that weak smile, and she nodded, trusting me as always. We brought her back to our place, and from then on, I took care of everything. Cooking meals she barely touched, cleaning up after our daughter, bathing her when she couldn't manage, and helping my wife

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shift positions because she was too frail to move on her own. She'd lie there, helpless, her body wasting away, and I could see the pain etched in her eyes. It tore me apart watching her slip further each day.

That's when Tahajjud became my lifeline. During those hours before sunrise, when the house was silent, and the weight of everything pressed hardest, I'd rise for prayer. I'd make wudu with cold water that jolted me awake, spread out my prayer mat in the dim light of the lamp, and pour my heart out to Allah. "Rabbi," I'd whisper in sujood, my forehead pressed to the ground, "cure her completely. Forgive her, heal her, but above all, guide her to You." Night after night, I'd beg for her guidance, tears soaking the prayer rug as I recounted our life together, pleading for mercy on her soul. I couldn't abandon her—not in this state, not ever. She was enduring agony right before me, and leaving her side felt impossible. But her health only worsened, the doctors' visits more grim each time.

We both had started learning about Islam before her illness struck hard. She'd listen as I shared what I'd read from the Quran or heard in lectures, nodding along and asking questions here and there. She knew I had reverted, and I believe it planted seeds in her heart. I longed to guide her to say the Shahadah, to make it official, but I held back, waiting for a moment when she felt stronger, when the pain didn't cloud everything.

One evening, I came home from the office, exhausted and worried as usual. She called out to me in this shattered voice, tears already falling. "I love you," she said, her words breaking. "Please, take care of our

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daughter." I rushed to her, wrapped her in my arms, and we both wept. I felt her warm tears on my shirt, heard her ragged breaths against my chest. I held her close, stroked her hair, and murmured, "Everything will be fine, you're going to be just fine."

That night, unable to sleep, I stayed beside her while she rested. When I finally saw her drift off to sleep, I quietly got up and performed Tahajjud again, my heart pouring out duas for her: "Rabbi, please… forgive her sins, please… grant her guidance before it's too late. Rabbi, please don't take her away from me."

The next morning, I woke up to a chill in the air. I reached for her hand—cold and lifeless. Tears still marked her closed eyes, as if she had been crying in those final moments. She was gone. My chest tightened, and a raw, guttural scream escaped me before I could hold it back. The world had shrunk to that one unbearable reality.

Our daughter toddled into the room, rubbing her eyes, confusion written across her tiny face. "Mama? Wake up," she whispered, her voice trembling. When it finally sank in, she began to cry, tiny snuffles that tore at my heart. I held her close, my own tears falling freely, and we clung to each other, the room echoing with our grief.

As I struggled to steady myself through the shock, my eyes noticed a folded paper on the bedside table. My hands trembled as I picked it up, my vision blurred by fresh tears. I unfolded it slowly, almost afraid to read what might be written. Her handwriting was delicate, shaky from

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weakness, yet every word pierced straight to my soul. She had poured her heart out—messages for our daughter about kindness, resilience, and the stories we'd shared; words for me filled with love, gratitude, and reminders to stay steadfast no matter what happens.

Near the end, she wrote something that made my heart both ache and swell: she had reverted to Islam on her own, silently, in the depths of her heart. She wrote the date and time and requested that we bury her as a Muslim.

"Pray for my forgiveness," she added, humbly confessing. In the second-to-last line, she scrawled the Shahadah in English, affirming her faith. And the very last line read:

"To Allah we belong, and to Him is our return."

I sank to the floor, holding our daughter, unable to speak. My cries shook my body, my chest heaving with grief too heavy to bear. She was gone, yet in that note, she had left me everything—her faith, her love, her hope for our daughter, and her final connection to Allah. We wept together, holding each other tight, hearts breaking in unison, wishing in vain for just one more moment, one more laugh, one more touch. Amid that unbearable pain, I felt an overwhelming mixture of sorrow and awe: sorrow for the loss that pierced my very soul, and awe at the mercy of Allah, who had guided her to Him even in her final moments.

It's been years now, and the pain of missing her never truly goes away. Our daughter grew up hearing stories about her mother, seeing her face

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in photos and videos. I've done my best to raise her as a Muslim, and I'm proud of the woman she has become.

Every night, I wake for Tahajjud, pouring my heart out to Allah—asking for my wife's forgiveness, praying for her soul, and hoping that one day we'll be together again.

Reflection

This story resonates deeply with many new converts to Islam. When someone adopts the faith, it can bring great joy and peace—but it can also cause pain, especially when family members remain non-Muslim. Losing a loved one who never accepted Islam or watching them suffer and pass away without guidance is a unique kind of heartbreak. This grief is something even the Prophet (peace be upon him) experienced. He loved his uncle, Abu Talib, very much, yet despite his uncle's unwavering support, he did not accept Islam. When Abu Talib passed away, the Prophet (peace be upon him) felt profound sorrow, showing us that love for family endures even when guidance is refused.

For converts who still have family members outside the fold, this story is a reminder of the power of Tahajjud. In those hours before Fajr, you can turn directly to Allah, pouring your heart out for the guidance and forgiveness of those you love. Your prayers can reach where your words

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cannot, and Allah listens in ways that we may not immediately see. Tahajjud becomes not just a moment of personal closeness to Allah, but also a means of hoping for the guidance of others.

For those born into Muslim families, this story is a reminder not to take your deen and your family for granted. Having a family that shares your deen, prays with you, guides you, and supports you is a blessing many recognize only when it is lost. Gratitude for this gift is essential; the relationships you have within the deen are an invaluable support in navigating life and drawing closer to Allah.

Ultimately, this story shows that love, loss, and faith are intertwined. Whether you are a revert facing the absence of family guidance or someone born into Islam blessed with a Muslim household, Tahajjud offers a space for connection, healing, and hope. It reminds us that even in moments of unbearable grief, Allah's mercy and guidance are within reach—both for ourselves and for those we love.

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Get Me Out of This Prison!

I was in jail during Ramadan. The days felt slow, heavy, and repetitive, with each one blending into the next. Nights seemed even longer. Thick walls. Locked doors. A silence that pressed in after the lights went out. Nothing interrupted it except guards walking the halls or the sound of keys clanking somewhere far away.

During Jumu'ah, the prison allowed imams to come in. One of them shared a dua and urged us to recite it during Tahajjud. It was simple and straightforward, but as soon as I heard it, something within me was motivated.

"Ya Allah, reunite me with my family — as quickly as possible."

At first, I didn't believe it. I was locked up, and my situation felt final. Concrete, steel doors, court dates — everything about my life seemed beyond my control. How could a dua reach past all of that?

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But Ramadan has a way of softening a person. Of bringing buried things to the surface. So I started praying.

Every night, I stood in the corner of my cell, facing what I believed to be right. I prayed on the bare floor, repeating the same dua again and again. Not because I was confident — but because it was all I had left. Just me, my prayer, and a hope that seemed almost impossible.

About a week after Ramadan ended, I had a court appearance. My stomach churned as I walked into the courtroom. The usual tension weighed on me — the judge, the lawyers, the routine procedures. Then something that should have been impossible happened. Because of an incredible oversight, the judge granted me OR — Own Recognizance. I was being released.

I couldn't believe it. I walked out of the courtroom in shock, my legs nearly trembling beneath me. The next moments felt surreal, as if the world had flipped upside down and then fixed itself just for me. That night, I was home, sitting at the dinner table with my family, hearing their voices, feeling the familiar warmth, tasting the freedom I had almost forgotten. For a brief moment, I felt truly alive in a way I hadn't in months.

The next day, reality hit hard. The "mistake" was exposed. My OR was revoked, and I had to go back. The burden of returning to confinement weighed even more. But then something incredible happened: I was moved to a new dorm—one where I knew a trustee from my old

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neighbourhood. SubhanAllah. Amid all those restrictions, Allah had woven a thread of familiarity and hope into my journey.

Months went by. I kept praying and hoping. I kept remembering that night at home, that fleeting taste of freedom and family that once seemed almost impossible. When my final hearing arrived, the details became crucial. The judge acknowledged the accidental release and that I voluntarily returned the next day. That detail, seemingly small to others, became pivotal in the court's decision.

My case was suspended, and the charges were dropped. As I write this now, I am home. I am free and with my family — for good.

Alhamdulillah.

Through everything, I realized that what seemed like a "mistake" was not truly a mistake at all. Allah accepted my dua and brought me back to my family, even if only for one night. That moment gave me the strength to face what was coming next.

Knowing that Allah had heard me changed everything. It carried me through the remaining days of confinement, steadied my heart, and drew me closer to Him. I returned to my cell with patience I didn't have before, and faith that no door is ever truly closed when Allah wills otherwise.

Tahajjud sustained me in that place. It wasn't just a prayer for release from prison — it became a source of strength and a sense of closeness

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to Allah. Looking back now, I see that every night I stood before Him mattered. Not one of them was wasted.

Reflection

Most of us have faced some sort of "prison," even if it's not constructed from walls and bars. It might be a job you can't quit, a broken marriage, or years of feeling trapped in life without any progress. For some, it's the longing to get married or start a family that hasn't materialized yet. For others, it's a repeated cycle of challenges—financial struggles, health issues, relationships—that seems to go on forever. These are our personal prisons, and they can feel just as oppressive as any cell.

And then there are the things we can't control. Much of life is outside our hands: the decisions of a judge, the outcome of a surgery, the actions of others, or the timing of events. We want control. We like control. We trust ourselves the most. But the reality is, we're never truly in control. Prophet Yusuf (AS) understood this. He relied on the prison inmate to speak to the king, but the man forgot him until the time Allah had destined. Yusuf (AS) had done his part—he was patient, steadfast, and kept his faith. The rest was in Allah's hands.

This story reveals the same truth. The man in prison did everything he could—he prayed, he hoped, he trusted in Allah—but the court, the

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lawyers, the judge—all were beyond his control. Yet, Allah used the sequence of events, even what seemed like mistakes, to answer his du'a at the right moment. That moment of release, brief as it was, gave him the strength to keep going, to endure, and to finally be reunited with his family.

We face the same challenges in our lives. We pray for guidance, relief, a spouse, or a solution—but often, the path doesn't unfold as we expect. The lesson is not to give up. Tahajjud teaches us patience, humility, and reliance on Allah. It reminds us that the One who sees everything, knows everything, and has power over everything is the One we must turn to. The effort is ours—we stand, pray, and ask, but the outcome belongs to Him.

When we let go of the illusion of control, we can finally find peace in the process. Life's "prisons" become tolerable, patience gains importance, and even the uncertainty of tomorrow turns into an opportunity to draw closer to Allah. Every night spent in prayer, every moment of hope during hardship, matters. Allah is always working, even when we cannot see it and even when we feel helpless.

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I Missed My Deadline

Last year, I was preparing for an exam to gain admission to a highly competitive academic program—one that accepts only twelve students per semester. It was my dream. I had spent months studying, making flashcards, watching lectures, skipping outings, and sacrificing sleep. I told myself, "Just push through. Just get in."

But somewhere along the way, I made a mistake. I missed the application deadline entirely. It wasn't because I was careless; I just got the date wrong. A small error that cost me everything. I was devastated. That night, I couldn't help but cry, feeling as though all my effort had been wasted. It was as if the doors had been slammed shut before I even had a chance to walk through.

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Lessons from This Chapter

This chapter reminds us that life is never completely within our control. No matter how carefully we plan, how hard we work, or how confident we feel, there will always be moments of uncertainty—times when we feel powerless. Sometimes, life traps us in our own "prisons": a job that confines us, a relationship that isn't working, a health scare, or years of waiting to get married or start a family.

Sometimes, it is the things we cannot control — like the outcome of an important exam, getting accepted into university, receiving immigration approval, or the timing of a pregnancy. These situations can feel just as heavy and confining as walls and bars, reminding us that ultimately, life unfolds according to Allah's wisdom, not ours.

The stories here show us two things: first, that we cannot control everything. The man in prison had no control over judges, lawyers, or court procedures. The man caring for his sick wife had no control over her illness or the doctors' outcomes. They did what they could—prayed, acted responsibly, remained patient—but ultimately, the results were in Allah's hands. This is a hard truth for most of us: we want to do everything ourselves because we trust ourselves the most, but our power is limited.

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Second, these stories teach us what to do when life feels out of our control: turn to Allah. Tahajjud, dua, and sincere reliance on Him become the tools that support us through uncertainty. They give us strength when the world feels heavy, patience when hope seems far away, and clarity when our hearts are overwhelmed. Just as Prophet Yusuf (AS) remained steadfast even when the inmate forgot him and his fate seemed stalled, we too must act with trust and let Allah's plan unfold.

In practical terms, when life feels uncontrollable:

- Accept that some outcomes are beyond your control, and that's okay.
- Do your part—pray, take responsible action, seek help where possible—but leave the results to Allah.
- Use moments of uncertainty to draw closer to Allah, build your patience, and strengthen your faith that He observes everything, even what we cannot see.

The key lesson is simple: your efforts are never wasted, and Allah is always at work—even during times when you feel helpless. Life might place you in "prisons" you cannot escape on your own, but trust that Allah's plan is always unfolding for your good, even when you cannot yet see it.

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Chapter Two

Where Are You, God?

There is a harsh truth many are too afraid to admit — the gradual drifting away from Allah, not through rebellion, but through fatigue, distraction, and hopelessness. Those who once felt close to Allah and the Prophet can suddenly find themselves questioning their religion, their purpose, or the meaning of life. Some get pulled into a cycle of sin they cannot escape, leaving confusion, guilt, and numbness in their wake. They are left asking the silent question:

How did I get here?

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This chapter explores what happens when people try to fill the spiritual emptiness with success, pleasure, distractions, or ideologies — and why none of it truly satisfies the soul. Losing connection with Allah often brings a deeper loss: of direction, purpose, and inner peace.

Through deeply personal reflections and experiences, this chapter traces the emotional and spiritual journey of someone who felt distant from Allah, trapped in cycles of sin, shame, and self-blame. It sheds light on how separation from faith can distort self-worth, drain purpose, and foster a despair that lurks beneath the surface of daily life. More importantly, it explores how this distance is not the end — but often the beginning of the return.

This chapter encourages the reader to honestly examine their relationship with Allah, their understanding of purpose, and how the heart can subtly drift when it is deprived of remembrance. It is not a lesson coming from above but a shared human experience—one that acknowledges weakness, confusion, and struggle while guiding toward hope, mercy, and return.

Above all, this chapter serves as an invitation. An invitation to pause, reflect, and consider whether the restlessness you feel might be a call back to something more profound. A reminder that no matter how far someone believes they have wandered, the path back to Allah remains open — waiting not for perfection but for a sincere step in His direction.

And that one sincere step can be taken through Tahajjud.

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Are You There, God? It's Me.

I reached a point where I felt I didn't belong anywhere. Life had become a series of grey mornings and heavy nights. I wasn't practising. I wasn't praying. I no longer truly knew what I believed. Religion seemed like a tool people used when they were desperate — and I had no desire to be desperate. Or so I told myself.

But deep down, I still held a flicker of faith. Barely a spark. Weak, fragile, hidden beneath years of cynicism and a darkness I thought had swallowed me whole. I had been diagnosed with PTSD and another mental health condition I barely remember now. Therapy helped somewhat, but it couldn't reach the emptiness I carried. I was barely managing at school, at home, or anywhere else. Dropping out sometimes seemed like the only option because I simply couldn't pull myself together. Even getting out of bed felt like an achievement — and some days, even that didn't happen at all.

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One night, I couldn't sleep. I kept waking up, drifting in and out, never really resting. I didn't know what Tahajjud was back then. All I knew was I was awake again, staring into the darkness, exhausted physically and mentally.

Eventually, I stopped trying to force myself back to bed. I thought, what's the point? I was already awake. Already broken. Already at my lowest ever.

So I got up.

Not because I felt spiritual. Not because I knew what I was doing. I didn't even know when Fajr was or if what I was about to do "counted." I just thought — why not? If prayer is something desperate people turn to, then I qualify. I had nothing left to protect—no pride left to lose.

So I stood there, feeling totally lost, and decided to give prayer a try.

The house was silent—the kind of silence that presses against your ears and chest. The floor felt cold beneath my knees, and my hands were stiff as I placed them in sajdah. My breathing was shallow and uncertain. For the first time in years, it seemed like something outside myself was noticing—watching over me, listening to the parts of me I hadn't dared speak aloud.

I prayed four rak'ahs. It felt like being cleansed in a way I didn't realize I needed, as if layers of guilt, exhaustion, and self-blame had been gently lifted, one by one. I wasn't suddenly healed, but I felt like I had

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been reset—like someone who had been holding their breath for too long and finally exhaled.

At that moment, I didn't feel new — I felt like I had come back. As if something inside me had returned home after being lost for a very long time.

After that night, everything shifted, though slowly. The days that followed weren't perfect. I still experienced anxiety, lingering depression, and moments when the fog would settle over me again. But now, there were cracks of light. I noticed small things: a friend's smile, the warmth of sunlight, the way my chest didn't feel quite as heavy in the mornings. I could sit through a lecture without panic bubbling up. I could answer an email without my hands trembling. Little by little, life started to feel colourful again.

And I started to see the subtle ways Allah had been guiding me all along. Opportunities I had overlooked, acts of kindness from strangers, unexpected support from situations that might have broken me — all of it felt interconnected, as if someone had been gently tilting the scale in my favour. I began to understand that the prayer I hadn't even taken seriously was a turning point. Not because it changed the world immediately, but because it changed me. My heart had started to find its way home before my mind even realized.

Looking back, I realize something I couldn't see at the time: you can crawl out even when you've hit rock bottom. It's about taking that first

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step, the one that seems impossible, and trusting that Allah sees the heart behind the hesitation.

I didn't expect to meet Allah that night; I thought I was just passing time. Still, He found me anyway. He appeared to me in the quiet of early morning, through my trembling hands and uncertain heart. That one night, unexpectedly, began a gentle, gradual rebuilding of faith, hope, and life itself.

Reflection

What truly mattered that night wasn't the number of raka'ahs, or how he accidentally prayed Tahajjud, or even the physical act of sujood itself. It was that he finally reached out to Allah. After years of distance, doubt, and despair, and feeling like he had nothing left to hold onto, he let go of pride and fear and simply asked for help. That moment — raw, imperfect, human — was the beginning of his return.

Sujood is the closest a servant can be to Allah, as the Prophet (peace be upon him) taught:

> A slave becomes nearest to his Rabb when he is in prostration. So increase supplications while prostrating.
>
> (Sahih Muslim)

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In that prostration, the weight of guilt, the silence of unspoken doubts, and the burden of exhaustion can finally meet the One who sees, knows, and understands. It isn't the posture alone that transforms, but the heart behind it — the sincerity of turning, even hesitantly, to Allah.

His story is not unique. Many young Muslims today find themselves in the same situation — questioning, struggling, or even turning away from deen. They look to ideologies, philosophies, and "isms" for guidance, searching for meaning in a world that often is disconnected from God. What they may not realize is that Islam provides answers to life's questions in every aspect: personal, social, political, spiritual, and moral. It is a complete way of life — one that becomes evident when the heart reconnects with the Creator.

This isn't about perfection. It isn't about flawlessly following a ritual. What matters is the act of turning, reaching, and being willing to humble oneself before Allah. Tahajjud, along with the sujood within it, creates the space for exactly that. It's a moment when the heart can start to feel at home, realization can surface, and the practical teachings of Islam can begin to make sense in everyday life.

For anyone feeling lost, distant, or on the brink of faith, the lesson is simple yet deep: it only takes that initial act of turning or rather, returning. Even if hesitant, even if imperfect, even in the silence of a sleepless night — Allah notices, Allah responds. Sometimes, that small step becomes the beginning of a journey that gradually brings light back into life,

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renews purpose, and reconnects the heart to the One who never turns away.

Tahajjud is more than just a prayer; it is a chance to find direction, regain strength, and sense Allah's closeness, which can begin to transform both inner and outer life. The story shows that even at rock bottom, the hand of mercy is never out of reach, and sometimes it arrives simply because someone chooses to bow down and ask.

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Are You Even Listening?

I've struggled with salah for years.

Not in the casual sense of missing a prayer here or there — but in a more messed-up way, where praying at all feels difficult. When days pass without prayer, guilt takes hold, yet it never fully motivates you to change.

Last year, we returned to Germany, where I was born. Something about returning unsettled something inside me. I felt a pressure I couldn't explain — not from anyone, but from within. A sense that I couldn't keep living the way I had been and that it was time to rebuild my relationship with prayer.

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Reflection

One of the biggest misconceptions about returning to Allah is that you must start perfectly. That you need everything sorted out before you can ask for more. That Tahajjud is only for those who are already consistent in prayer. But Allah never says that. In fact, He often speaks to those who feel they have failed themselves.

> O My servants who have transgressed against themselves [by sinning], do not despair of the mercy of Allah. Indeed, Allah forgives all sins. Indeed, it is He who is the Forgiving, the Merciful.
>
> [Qur'an 39:53]

Notice who this verse addresses. Not perfect or disciplined, but those burdened by their own faults. Struggling with prayer doesn't mean the heart is distant; often, it's alive but weighed down by exhaustion, depression, guilt, or life's challenges. The pressure to "fix everything" can sometimes hinder any change.

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I Hate What I See in the Mirror

I didn't fall apart all at once. It started slowly, in ways that were easy to overlook—then the snowball turned into an avalanche.

There was no sense of time. Hours disappeared into screens — endless scrolling, senseless videos, anything that could give me that quick rush of dopamine. That fleeting moment. That instant where I didn't have to feel empty, shallow, and lonely. I told myself I was just tired, just bored, just not wanted by anyone. But I knew better. I was chasing a high. Not drugs, not alcohol — something far more disgusting, but just as numbing.

I was trying to justify my habits to myself. But the truth was harder to face: I was running. Running from myself, from responsibility, from the weight of what I had become.

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I wasn't truly living anymore. I knew my soul had died a long time ago.

There was a time when sin bothered me. When guilt would settle heavily in my chest and push me toward repentance. But over time, even that faded. The guilt dulled. The shame softened. What once shook me began to feel normal. My heart didn't ache the way it used to — and that scared me more than anything else. I had heard that when the heart hardens, it stops feeling. I was living proof.

Prayer had become distant and meaningless. I found myself performing the actions, but they carried no real significance. Then the days went by without salah. Nights were spent numbing myself with distractions, even though I didn't truly enjoy them. I made many excuses, telling myself I was just going through something temporary. But is it really temporary if you've been doing this for over 9 years? Deep down, I knew I was lost — but acknowledging and admitting it felt heavier than remaining lost.

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Reflection

This story is more than just an individual's struggle. It serves as a reminder for anyone fighting addiction, despair, or habits that seem impossible to break. The night's journey — from darkness, shame, and numbness to rising, laying down a prayer mat, and praying — exemplifies a simple truth: no matter how far you have fallen, you are never beyond Allah's mercy.

Addiction, whether to substances, screens, or shameful habits, dulls the heart. It makes the soul heavy, the guilt less harsh, and the shame fade away. It convinces us that we are unworthy, that the mistakes we've made too many times cannot be forgiven. But this story reminds us that even when the heart feels as hard as stone, Allah's mercy is closer and more penetrable than we think.

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Lessons from This Chapter

At its core, this chapter is about return — not just to prayer, but to purpose. It is the moment when a person realizes that something essential is missing, even if life appears full on the surface. It speaks to the crisis many face today: being alive, functioning, even "successful," yet spiritually empty, disconnected, and lost.

The stories in this chapter reveal a painful truth: when a person drifts away from Allah, they do not simply lose a set of rituals. They begin to lose direction and meaning. The heart, created to know and worship its Creator, does not remain neutral when that connection weakens. It seeks something else to fill the void. As a result, people turn to distractions, habits, pleasures, ideologies, or identities, hoping to find purpose in what was never meant to provide it.

This is where the danger lies. When faith fades, something else always takes its place. For some, it becomes the pursuit of wealth or status. For others, pleasure, validation, or escapism. For many today, it becomes ideology — the belief that fulfillment can be found through self-definition, self-worship, or complete independence from God. Yet no matter the form, the result is often the same: a growing sense of emptiness, confusion, and loss of direction.

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Islam does not merely offer rules; it offers answers to the most fundamental questions of human existence:

Why am I here?

What is my purpose?

Where am I going?

When these questions go unanswered, the soul drifts. When they are answered incorrectly, the soul suffers. Only when they are answered through revelation does life start to make sense again. The heart finds peace not through excess, achievement, or escape — but through alignment with its Creator.

This chapter illustrates how easily a person can fall into a cycle of sin, shame, and self-blame, and how quickly that cycle can lead them to believe they are unworthy of returning to Allah. Shaytan relies on this lie. He doesn't need to persuade someone to disbelieve outright; it's enough to convince them they are too broken to be forgiven. However, the truth, repeated throughout the Qur'an and Sunnah, is that Allah's mercy is not fragile. It is not withdrawn due to repeated mistakes or delayed because of weakness. It remains accessible until the very end.

What these stories show is that returning to Allah is not an act of strength only for the righteous — it is an act of humility anyone can do. Often, it starts not with conviction, but with desperation. Not with confidence,

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but with collapse. And in that collapse, when the heart finally admits its need, Allah responds.

The journey back can be slow and deeply personal. It may start with a single prayer, a moment of honesty, or even a realization that the path one is on no longer leads anywhere worth going. But once that turn is made, no matter how small, it reorients the entire direction of a person's life.

This chapter reminds us that the crisis of faith many face today is not a sign of failure — it is an invitation to return. A return to meaning. A return to purpose. A return to the One who created the heart and knows exactly how to heal it.

In a noisy world full of distractions and empty promises, Islam offers true clarity. While the world chases temporary happiness, it gives a lasting purpose. When many feel confused or lost, it gently guides each person back—not with criticism, but with compassion.

The question is not whether Allah is willing to accept us back. The question is whether we are willing to accept Him.

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Chapter Three
Finding Allah's Treasure

There are few things more terrifying than staring at your bank account and wondering how you'll make it through the month.

When bills are due, savings are running low, and no income is coming in, the pressure can become overwhelming. You apply for jobs, rewrite your resume, attend interviews, and follow all the "right" steps—yet nothing changes. Days turn into weeks. Weeks into months. The waiting itself becomes exhausting.

At night, the mind races — rent, groceries, family responsibilities, the future. Even the strongest among us can feel shaken when their efforts don't seem to pay off. In moments like these, a difficult question may

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arise: If Allah provides, why does it sometimes feel like nothing is coming?

Islam teaches that Allah is Ar-Razzaq—the Provider. But provision isn't limited to a paycheck or a direct deposit. Allah provides through means we can't always see, control, or predict. Sometimes, He delays what we ask for. Sometimes, He redirects us. And sometimes the provision arrives only after the heart is forced to let go of its assumptions about how things are supposed to work.

The stories in this chapter come from people who reached that point—those who were unemployed, financially strained, or burdened with responsibilities they felt unprepared for. They did not stop trying, but they also reached a moment where effort alone was no longer enough. That is when Tahajjud became a part of their lives—not as a ritual, but as a turning point.

What follows are not stories of instant success or effortless outcomes. They are stories of people who struggled, asked Allah at every opportunity, and witnessed provision arrive in ways they did not anticipate.

This chapter is for anyone who is waiting, worried, or feeling stretched thin. It serves as a reminder that reliance on Allah is active, and effort without reliance is incomplete. Rizq does not vanish because circumstances tighten, and Allah never abandons those who turn to Him.

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We Regret to Inform You…

I had been unemployed for nearly a year, and it felt as though every door in my life had been shut. I applied to more than nine hundred jobs—no exaggeration. I attended over forty interviews within a few months, each one starting with hope and ending the same way. Every morning, I checked my email with anticipation, telling myself that today might finally be different. Most days, there was nothing. And when there was, it was always the same polite rejection, carefully worded, impersonal, and final. I memorized the phrasing. I recognized it instantly, even before finishing the sentence.

I rewrote my résumé endlessly. I adjusted wording, changed formats, rewrote bullet points, tailored cover letters, and reshaped my experience in every possible way. I tried sounding more confident, then more humble, then more eager. Still, nothing changed. Eventually, I found myself applying for positions I once thought were beneath my qualifications.

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I had experience. I had an education. I had worked hard to build a life. Yet none of it seemed to matter. Over time, the rejection stopped feeling professional and began to feel personal. The disappointment turned into exhaustion, and the exhaustion slowly became something heavier—a sense of being lost.

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Reflection

After hundreds of applications and dozens of interviews, we can clearly see that the person made every effort. They had the right qualifications and experience, yet nothing moved. But why? That is often when Allah removes the illusion of control. When every strategy fails, what remains is the truth: no résumé, no referral, no hiring manager can place provision in your hands unless Allah allows it.

This does not mean effort is pointless. It means effort without reliance is empty. A believer first asks Allah, then takes the means, understanding that the means themselves have no power. When this balance is lost, rejection can feel overwhelming, and self-worth can start to fade. When the balance is restored, effort continues without despair, because provision is no longer expected from people.

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I Struck Gold

Five years ago, I was working as an entry-level accountant in New York, earning $70,000 a year.

It was okay — enough to get by. Rent was paid. Groceries found their way into the fridge. But then I got married.

And suddenly, "enough" didn't feel like enough anymore.

Rent, groceries, bills… everything became more expensive. New York isn't an affordable place to live. But this was no longer just about the numbers. It was about responsibility.

I now had a wife. Someone I was responsible for and wanted to care for. I longed to give her a life where she never had to worry about money—where she could walk into a store and buy something without checking the price tag.

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But instead, I was the one checking. Every time she picked up something while shopping, I'd glance at the price, calculate it in my head, and quietly tally up how much it was going to cost. I didn't say anything. I didn't want her to see me stressed.

Meanwhile, I wore the same few shirts and the same old jeans. I didn't buy anything for myself, not because I was being frugal, but because every dollar I saved could help make her life easier. I wanted her to feel like a queen. That was the kind of husband I aspired to be.

She didn't want to work, and I didn't want her either.

She wanted to stay home, raise a family, and focus on being a mother when the time came—and I fully supported that.

But deep down, I was scared.

Because the future started playing in my head over and over again.

What about when we have kids? Diapers, medical visits, formula, and baby clothes—why are they so expensive? Then there's a stroller, a car seat, maternity clothes, and all the unexpected costs that come with raising a child.

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Reflection

Rizq holds deep significance in Islam. It's not just about money or how much you earn, but in fact, Rizq can also come in the form of a spouse or children. The peace, support, and stability within a home are all part of what Allah provides. Many men will tell you that after marriage, unexpected doors began to open—raises, promotions, or better job opportunities. This is no coincidence. It reflects a deeper truth: Allah is Ar-Razzaq, and when someone takes a lawful step that Allah loves, Allah expands provisions in ways that cannot be planned or measured.

This directly challenges a common misconception—that a man must be financially "set" or even "rich" before getting married, or that marriage is a burden that drains wealth. Islam does not require luxury. It requires responsibility. As long as a man can meet the basic financial obligations of marriage, delaying it out of fear is unnecessary. Marriage does not reduce Rizq; rather, Allah places barakah in the lives of those who accept this responsibility with sincerity and trust.

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Lessons from This Chapter

Financial stress is one of the heaviest burdens we carry.

Whether it's unemployment, rising bills, family pressure, inflation, or simply the desire to be independent, Rizq is something every heart worries about. It keeps people awake at night. It can lead them to compromise their values. It can even shake someone's faith. Your mind constantly asks these questions:

Will I have enough?

Will I be able to provide?

Will my children have what they need?

What if I never break free from this cycle of stress?

In today's world, this fear is everywhere.

You scroll on your phone and see people living lives of ease, including vacations, luxury, weddings, and homes.

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Chapter Four
Love, Written Before the Heavens

Fifty thousand years before the sky was introduced to the sea, Allah wrote your name next to the one you would marry. He inscribed the names of the people you would love, those who would love you, the children who would call you mother or father, and the family your life would eventually centre around. Long before hearts met, before prayers were uttered, before waiting and longing ever began—these connections were already written.

Yet living through them rarely feels simple.

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Love is one of the strongest forces in the human heart. The desire to love and to be loved is natural. It influences decisions, tests patience, and often brings people to their knees in prayer. In this chapter, love appears in different forms and at different stages—sometimes delayed, sometimes unexpected, and sometimes bittersweet.

This chapter is not about ideal love stories. It is about how love unfolds when it is placed in Allah's hands—when people choose the halal path, even when it feels harder, slower, or more painful. It shows how what was written long before the creation of the heavens and the earth eventually finds its way into people's lives, through prayer, trust, and timing that only Allah controls.

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Love in the Last Third of the Night

It was the last day of our university year. Final exams had wrapped up. Everyone around me in the hallway was chatting, laughing, and discussing questions. I had always been a quiet student. I didn't mingle much; most classmates sat in mixed groups, and that wasn't something I was comfortable with. Talking to non-mahrams didn't feel right to me.

As I walked past the crowd with my eyes lowered, my heart felt heavy. It was the kind of weight you feel when something is coming to an end. At the main gate, I turned around one last time. And there she was… emerging from the science building.

Her name was Maryam.

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She was always different. Quiet, modest, always in her hijab. Like me, she didn't talk much. She carried herself with dignity. There was a kind of Haya in her eyes and a strength in her silence. That day, she looked at me as if asking me to stop. My chest tightened, but I kept walking.

I could feel my anxiety building in my chest as I sat in the car. Deep down, I knew this might be the last time I'd ever see her.

But something happened that afternoon.

I checked my Instagram and saw a red dot on my message icon. I rarely get messages, so I was curious. I opened it, and to my surprise, it was from her. It said:

> Asalamu alaykum. I pray you're well.
>
> After observing your character and deen, I believe there may be compatibility between us for marriage.
>
> If you're not already committed and are open to pursuing this further in a halal and respectful way, I've shared my father's contact below.

Right then and there, I knew this was the woman I wanted to marry. In a time of fitnah and casual free mixing, she chose modesty. She approached me with dignity and in a halal way. I knew I had found a gem I couldn't afford to lose.

But…

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I couldn't help but think I wasn't financially ready to get married. I was only in my early twenties. What could I give her? Will I be able to provide her the life she deserves?

I didn't know what to do. So, I did what I always did when I felt helpless.

I got up for Tahajjud.

I wept in sujood that night, begging Allah to guide me. To take over, because I couldn't.

The next day, with a heavy heart, I wrote back:

Wa alaikum assalam,

I really appreciate your message and really respect the way you approached this.

After giving this a lot of thought, I want to be honest. Right now, I'm not financially stable, and I don't feel I'm in a position to proceed with marriage as it truly deserves. Because of that, I wouldn't want to involve families before I'm ready.

That said, I do want you to know that I hold your character and deen in high regard, and I respect you greatly for how you approached this. I trust Allah's timing in all things, and whatever He decrees will be best for us both.

May Allah grant you the best in this life and the next.

I hit send. Closed the app. Tossed my phone and went for a walk.

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A few minutes later, I checked again.

Unseen.

An hour passed… still unseen.

Then… **Seen.**

My heart started pounding. I refreshed repeatedly.

Seen 5 mins ago.

Seen 10 mins ago.

Seen 30 mins ago.

Seen 5 hours ago.

No reply.

I didn't even know what I was hoping she'd say. Maybe she'd wait for me? Perhaps nothing at all. But looking back… I'm glad she said nothing.

Even though I turned her down for now, something inside me told me our paths would cross again.

That night, I prayed Tahajjud again. And the next night. And the night after that. I didn't miss a single one.

I only asked for one thing.

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"Ya Allah, if she's written for me, make it easy. Keep her safe until I'm ready. I leave this to You."

I reminded myself: Allah is never unaware of the hearts that cry in Tahajjud.

A few years went by. I began my own business. Stability arrived gradually. I was now in my mid-20s. My parents started discussing marriage. I kept postponing it softly, still hoping for a miracle.

And one day… it came.

I came home from work, and my little sister looked at me with that strange smile and said, "A family has sent you a proposal. Apparently, you and the girl went to the same university."

I asked her for the name

When she said it, my heart skipped a beat.

Maryam.

Could it be her?

It can't be. My heart braced for disappointment just in case it was another Maryam. But then my mother shared the family details… and her picture.

It was her.

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I felt as if I had just witnessed a miracle from Allah. I don't believe words can ever truly express what I experienced in that moment.

I was trying my best to hold back my tears.

We held our nikah in the most beautiful way, at the mosque with family and friends, exactly as we wanted.

I wanted to share this story because it proves what Tahajjud can do and the power it holds. It also shows what happens when you choose halal over haram, even when it's painful. It's about trusting Allah's timing, even when nothing seems to make sense.

Because without trusting Allah, I would have been fortunate enough to marry someone as precious as her.

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Reflection

This story highlights the beauty, challenge, and immense reward of choosing the halal path in love and marriage. In a world where instant gratification is so easy to access, with apps and casual dating making connections quick and fleeting, the halal route often feels slow, restrictive, and even frustrating. It demands patience, self-control, and trust — qualities that are tested when the heart longs for companionship, love, and emotional closeness.

The contrast is clear: the haram path offers immediate satisfaction, instant connection, and fleeting pleasure. However, these shortcuts come with a cost — instability, heartbreak, and long-term issues. Real-life examples are all around us: relationships that begin casually or impulsively often end in divorce, emotional pain, or lifelong regrets. Infatuation, though intense in youth, is temporary, and it cannot support the responsibilities, patience, and commitment that true love and marriage require.

Allah says in Surah Ar-Rum (30:21):

> And of His signs is that He created for you from yourselves mates that you may find tranquillity in them; and He placed between you affection and mercy. Indeed in that are signs for a people who give thought.

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This verse teaches us a profound truth: love and mercy are gifts from Allah granted after marriage, not before. These intense emotions, the attraction or infatuation we may feel, are merely a shadow of the true love and mercy that Allah bestows when hearts are united in a halal, sincere, and protected union. True love is not just feeling affection — it involves taking responsibility for another soul, nurturing them, protecting them, and remaining steadfast even when it is difficult, inconvenient, or uncomfortable.

The protagonist in this story faced a familiar test: he could have taken the easier route, given in to impatience, or pursued shortcuts. Instead, he chose the halal path, placing his trust fully in Allah. He prayed Tahajjud night after night, surrendering his desires, asking for guidance, and leaving the outcome to the One who knows best. This is not passive waiting — it is active reliance on Allah, combined with the discipline of avoiding what is haram and pursuing what is right.

The reward of this choice is multi-dimensional. On the surface, Allah blessed him with a spouse perfectly suited for him — someone who shares his values, treats him with respect and dignity, and with whom he can create a family. But deeper than that, the story shows inner peace and spiritual calm that come from obeying Allah's guidance and trusting His plan. Choosing halal, no matter how difficult it seems at the moment, nourishes the soul and invites barakah into our lives.

For those struggling with the desire for companionship or love, this story serves as a reminder: the journey of patience and perseverance in halal

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love is not only the correct path, but also the one that Allah blesses in ways the heart cannot yet understand. Those who remain steadfast, who hold onto their faith and trust in Allah, will find that their efforts are not in vain. Even when circumstances seem slow, unclear, or difficult, Allah's timing is flawless. His wisdom exceeds ours, and what He ordains is much better than anything we could plan for ourselves.

This story also highlights the power of Tahajjud. Night prayer is not merely a ritual; it is a space where the heart opens up to Allah, where guidance is sought, and where trust in Him is strengthened. Consistent dua, coupled with steadfastness in choosing what is halal, turns challenges into blessings, longing into fulfillment, and struggle into contentment.

Ultimately, the lesson is clear: the halal path may be difficult, but it leads to love that is genuine, steady, and divinely blessed. The haram path may seem easier in the moment, but it cannot provide the peace, mercy, and barakah that come from Allah. When we choose halal, pray sincerely, and trust in Him, the outcomes — whether in love, marriage, or life — can feel nothing short of miraculous.

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Love on My Doorstep

To this day, I still can't believe how Allah answered my prayer.

I'm not someone who prays Tahajjud often, but on my birthday two years ago, I felt compelled to do so. I woke up during the night to pray, and for the first time, I made a very specific dua.

Usually, my duas were more general. I'd say things like,

"Ya Allah, give me whatever You think is best… whenever You think the time is right."

But that night, I broke down and asked Allah from the heart:

"Ya Allah, please send my life partner into my life before my next birthday. And let it happen in a halal way. No haram relationships. Just someone who is good and honest."

That was it.

I didn't pray Tahajjud again after that.

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And honestly… I forgot I even made that duaa.

Months passed.

Then I found out something strange.

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Reflection

When I make dua, when will it be answered?

Many people grapple with this question. Some ask it hoping for answers, others with anxiety, and some give up over time because they grow weary of waiting.

One of the key lessons from this story is understanding that being guided to make dua is not coincidental. A person does not suddenly wake up one night and ask Allah for something specific without reason. When Allah allows a heart to ask, it is already a sign of divine care. There is no situation in which Allah grants someone the ability and desire to make dua except that He intends to respond. Therefore, the focus should not be on how or when the dua will be answered, but on appreciating the blessing of being able to make it at all.

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I Didn't Find My Spouse Attractive

I had been living and working abroad for nearly twenty years. I started with nothing and, by the grace of Allah, built a stable life. Financially, I was comfortable. Over the years, I learned patience, responsibility, and complete reliance on Allah.

My father was a righteous man, someone I trusted completely. When the time came for marriage, I told him, "I leave it entirely in your hands. Choose a wife for me." I believed he knew best, that he would consider both religion and character, and I surrendered myself to his decision.

Months went by, and at last, he spoke to me. He had found someone. She was religious, had good character, and came from a practicing family. I agreed to the nikah without ever meeting her. I trusted him completely.

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The day of the nikah arrived. The formalities were done, and suddenly, I was alone with her for the first time. I lifted her veil, and my heart sank. I couldn't hide my surprise. I didn't find her attractive at all. My disappointment was immediate and stark, and she noticed. I said nothing, made an excuse, and went to sleep.

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Reflection

Some of you reading this might see yourselves as unattractive. Maybe you've never liked your appearance. Perhaps someone said something that stuck with you. And in a world where Hollywood and social media continually promote unrealistic beauty standards, especially for women, and even for men, it's easy to feel like you'll never measure up. It doesn't help when you're constantly comparing yourself to filters, influencers, or people who seem perfect.

However, the truth is that none of that defines your worth. Not to Allah. Not in the things that matter.

But let this story be a reminder: real beauty doesn't come from faces, but it comes from the inside. From your deen. From actions. From who you are when no one's watching.

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You're Not Having a Baby

When I found out I was pregnant, I didn't tell anyone what I was secretly wishing for. In my heart, I asked Allah for a boy.

I had spent most of my life mothering my little sister and loving her as if she were my own child. And this time, I just wanted to experience what it's like to raise a son. To hold a baby boy in my arms and watch him grow.

On the other hand, my husband had always longed for a daughter. He was deeply touched by the hadith of the Prophet (peace be upon him) that whoever raises daughters well will be rewarded with Paradise. He would often say, "My daughter will be my door to Jannah."

One evening, we were curled up together under the blanket in our bedroom. I finally shared the big news that I was pregnant. His face lit up with joy.

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"What are you hoping for?" he asked, beaming.

"I'm hoping for a baby boy," I said with a shy smile.

He grinned and nodded. "And I'm hoping for a daughter," he said softly.

Then he looked at me with soft eyes and said,

Let's both pray at Tahajjud as a friendly challenge. You ask for a boy, and I'll ask for a girl. Perhaps Allah will grant one of us what we desire.

That night and many nights afterward, we would wake up before Fajr. Wrapped in blankets, eyes half-open but hearts fully alive, we poured out our duas into the darkness.

We weren't really competing. We were just excited.

Two souls. Two hearts. One Lord. One prayer each.

Then came the first scan.

We asked the doctor, "How's the baby doing?"

She said, "You're not having a baby."

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Reflection

This story reminds us how easily we set limits on our dua, often without realizing it. We ask Allah hesitantly, adjusting our hopes to what feels realistic or likely. But Allah is not bound by what we perceive as possible. When two hearts turned to Him in Tahajjud—each asking for something different—Allah did not choose between their duas. He answered both. This serves as a reminder that Allah's power is not limited by our expectations, and that any dua made in His sight is never insignificant.

One lesson here is that we should not be conservative in what we ask of Allah. Our role is not to calculate outcomes, probabilities, or feasibility. Our role is to ask with humility and trust. The example of Prophet Sulayman (AS) clearly teaches us this. He did not ask for an ordinary kingdom; he asked for a kingdom unlike any before or after him, and Allah granted it. This shows us that asking boldly is not a lack of adab when directed toward Allah—it is a reflection of certainty in who He is.

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Lessons from This Chapter

Love is one of the most powerful forces in the world. It is human nature to desire love and to want to be loved, and we see in these stories how that desire can drive someone to stand in the last third of the night in Tahajjud, pouring their heart out to Allah.

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Chapter Five
Between Pain and Qadr

If Allah loves me, then why does He make me suffer?

Time and again, life unfolds in unpredictable ways. Illness, loss, heartbreak, or unexpected obstacles arrive without warning. Moments we thought we understood suddenly shift, leaving us questioning, fearing, or even despairing.

For a believer, these moments carry a deeper meaning. They are not random misfortunes or mere accidents. They are signs, tests, and reminders of Allah's wisdom and mercy. They invite reflection, surrender, and trust in a reality beyond what our eyes can see.

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This chapter explores the link between trial and healing, pain and mercy, and the seen and unseen. Through personal stories of loss, illness, and unexpected recovery, it demonstrates how turning to Allah, especially through Tahajjud and dua, can turn suffering into closeness, weakness into strength, and despair into hope.

It also examines the concept of Qadr, Allah's divine decree, illustrating how what seems like hardship might conceal mercy, and what appears to be delay could be a form of preparation. Through these reflections, readers are encouraged to view trials not as random misfortune but as part of a meaningful plan, where every tear, struggle, and act of patience holds significance.

By the end of this chapter, the hope is that the reader will understand a profound truth: even in the darkest moments, Allah is present, guiding, protecting, and working in ways far beyond what we imagine.

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Thirteen Years of Suffering

For over thirteen years, trauma cast a shadow over my life. Eventually, it started to manifest in my body. First, it was mild—headaches, fatigue, a heaviness I couldn't explain. Over time, it worsened. Limbs that wouldn't move properly. Hallucinations. Nausea. Paralyzing muscle stiffness. Difficulty breathing. Some days, I couldn't even walk. Medications offered no relief. Hospitals became routine; emergency rooms, tests, IVs—they became my new normal.

I felt trapped inside my own body, watching it fail me bit by bit. Every plan, every dream, and every simple daily task felt impossible. My mind screamed for help, but my body was slowly shutting down.

One night, while scrolling through Instagram, I came across a reel about Tahajjud. I had heard of it before, but I never truly understood it. The video explained how Allah descends to the lowest level of heaven,

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asks His servants what they want, and gives it to them. I was so desperate to try anything. I didn't go into it expecting miracles. I didn't even ask for healing. I just wanted to feel connected to Allah, to have something to hold onto while everything else fell apart.

So I began waking up for Tahajjud. At first, it was awkward; I didn't know what to do or say. But then, the nights became a sort of refuge for me. I poured out my fear, my frustration, my grief, and my helplessness. I let myself feel utterly dependent on Him.

Then one morning, I noticed a change. My symptoms started to fade. Medications that once felt necessary were no longer needed. The hospital visits that had punctuated my life for so long came to an end. I could breathe. I could move. I could function. My doctors were amazed; I was amazed. No one could explain it.

I realized then that healing had arrived — not through any drug, medical treatment, or scientific breakthrough, but simply by turning to Allah and seeking His closeness. He had restored me, and the body that had betrayed me for so long finally started to feel like home once more.

I still carry pieces of those years—some symptoms, some trauma—but I am no longer captive to them. I am free to live, free to feel, and free from those dreadful hospital visits.

Through Tahajjud, Allah granted me something I never expected: shifa, mercy, and rebirth.

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Reflection

Our bodies and minds are deeply connected. Pain in one often manifests in the other. Trauma stored in the heart can appear in the body, and physical illnesses can influence the spirit.

Healing is not always achieved through medicine, procedures, or therapy. Sometimes, it comes through surrender, trust, and entrusting the heart to Allah's care. There are moments when the body feels weak, the mind is exhausted, and the pain is so relentless that words cannot express it. Yet, Allah's knowledge is complete; He perceives what we cannot articulate. He understands the depth of our struggle, the burden of unseen weights, and the desire for help even before we express it.

Drawing nearer to Allah through worship, prayer, and dua' creates a space for the soul to find peace. It soothes the heart, fortifies the mind, and enables the body to respond. Sometimes, what appears to be a miraculous recovery is not merely a change in symptoms but rather a shift in the unseen layers of trust, hope, and surrender. The body begins to feel safe again when the heart learns where it truly belongs.

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Your Best Option is Surgery

At first, I thought it was nothing.

Maybe I slept in the wrong position. Maybe I pulled a muscle. My lower back had been aching for a few days, but I brushed it off. I didn't stop to rest or visit the doctor. I figured it would get better on its own. It usually did.

But this time, it didn't.

As Ramadan arrived, the pain started to get worse. It crept in slowly, then hit all at once. Bending became painful. Sitting required effort. At night, I'd lie in bed, shifting from one side to the other, trying to find a position that didn't make me want to cry.

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Still, I tried to carry on. I went to Taraweeh at the mosque, as I always do. But while others bent and prostrated easily, I stood there, stiff and in pain. Then there was a point when I could hardly pray at all.

Sleep became difficult, as did work. I found myself leaning forward in my chair to avoid putting pressure on my spine. I stopped driving long distances. Even simple tasks—like tying my shoes or picking something up from the floor—became things I had to plan for in advance.

Eventually, I gave in and saw a doctor.

After a few tests and a brief exam, he looked at me and said, "You have a pilonidal cyst."

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Reflection

Sickness is one of the hardest tests a person can face. It takes away your comfort, energy, and sometimes, your dignity. You can't think clearly. You can't sleep. You start to feel trapped inside your own body.

But healing—that's something only Allah can give.

Doctors can diagnose, medicine can ease the pain, and surgery can remove what's visible. But shifa'—true healing—only comes from Allah. He calls Himself Ash-Shafi, the One who cures.

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> And when I am ill, it is He who cures me.
>
> [Qur'an 26:80]

The Prophet Ayyub (AS) endured illness for years, so severe that his body deteriorated, and people kept their distance. Yet, he never complained. He only said to Allah:

> Indeed, adversity has touched me, and You are the most merciful of the merciful.
>
> [Qur'an 21:83]

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Soul of My Soul

We had been trying to have a baby for a while.

Anyone who has struggled with fertility understands this odd mix of hope and heaviness — believing it can happen while each month quietly tests your patience. For me, there was an extra layer: I had PCOS. I knew that conceiving naturally would be difficult. Still possible, yes. But not easy.

So we started treatment.

Hormones.

Bloodwork.

Schedules.

Monitoring.

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I always thought fertility treatment would be clinical, like following a manual. But it wasn't. Each appointment was a rollercoaster of emotions — the waiting, the numbers, the predictions. It was overwhelming. My body felt disconnected from itself, and so did my emotions.

To give myself extra help, I even turned to Tahajjud.

I started praying Tahajjud regularly. One night, I woke up and prayed; then on another night, I did the same. Over time, it became a routine. During the hours before Fajr, I would sit on my prayer mat, make long, heartfelt duas, and talk to Allah as if I were talking to a friend. I would sometimes cry, asking Allah to bless us with a child full of mercy and goodness.

Our first treatment cycle failed.

I remember the moment so vividly. Sitting on the edge of the bed, holding the negative test and staring at it long after I already understood what it meant. I didn't cry. I didn't scream. I was just really disappointed.

But I didn't give up.

My heart still believed. I did istikhara. I kept praying — especially on Friday nights. No matter how exhausted I was, I would get up. Something inside kept telling me to keep going.

Then came the second cycle.

And this time…

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We got the news.

I was pregnant.

It didn't sink in right away. I just sat there, holding the report and reading the same line over and over. Later that day, I placed my hand on my stomach and made dua, feeling a sense of relief and peace I hadn't experienced in months.

When we found out the baby was a girl, it suddenly hit us — this was real. We were going to become parents to a daughter!

We felt excited, cautious, yet eager, and tried to temper our expectations, telling ourselves to stay grounded. But as soon as the news sank in, our excitement overtook our caution. We began imagining the small details—what she might look like, what her personality might be, and how our lives would change. We started painting her room in soft pastel colours, carefully arranging tiny pieces of furniture and choosing stuffed animals to line her crib. We debated names, tried out various options, and even went window-shopping for baby clothes, envisioning her tiny outfits hanging neatly in our home. It was all small, simple joys—but each one filled us with wonder and anticipation. Despite our initial caution, we couldn't help but get carried away. Finally, we were becoming parents, and the reality felt like a dream we didn't want to wake from.

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Reflection

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Lessons from This Chapter

If Allah is truly Merciful, why would He allow this to happen?

It's a question asked by skeptics, the grieving, and sometimes secretly by believers themselves. And Islam does not shy away from this question. In fact, the Qur'an addresses it directly.

Belief in Qadr does not mean ignoring pain. It means recognizing that our perspective is limited, while Allah's knowledge is boundless. What we see is just a mere pixel; what He sees is the whole picture.

Allah reminds us:

> But perhaps you hate a thing and it is good for you; and perhaps you love a thing and it is bad for you. And Allah knows, while you know not.
>
> [Qur'an 2:216]

This truth is clearly demonstrated in the story of Musa (AS) and Khidr in Surah Al-Kahf — a chapter the Prophet (peace be upon him) advised us to revisit often, especially on Fridays. It undoubtedly offers many lessons.

Musa (AS), a prophet of Allah, witnesses acts that seem unjust and cruel: a boat being damaged, a child being killed, and kindness shown where it

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appears undeserved. At every turn, Musa (AS) struggles because what he sees conflicts with his understanding of justice. Only later is the wisdom revealed: the damaged boat was saved from seizure, the child was spared a future that would have shattered his parents' faith, and the good deed protected orphans who had no idea Allah was watching over them.

The lesson is powerful: what looked like loss was actually protection, and what seemed like pain was a mercy in disguise.

This is the perspective Islam encourages us to adopt toward hardship: not with denial, but with trust. Not by pretending it doesn't hurt, but by believing that Allah's wisdom exceeds our understanding.

Belief in Qadr does not remove grief. It provides it with purpose.

It enables a person to say, "I don't understand this now, but I trust the One who does." It permits the heart to ache without despair, to surrender without giving up. It reminds us that Allah does not wrong His servants — ever. If He withholds something, it is not out of cruelty, but out of care. If He delays, it is not neglect, but intention.

And during times when the burden feels too heavy to carry alone, Islam provides a refuge. Tahajjud is not a ritual only for the spiritually elite; it is a personal connection between a servant and their Lord.

A door that always remains open.

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Lessons from This Book

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As we close this book, one theme has echoed through every story: life is rarely entirely within our control. Challenges arrive unexpectedly, others' decisions influence our circumstances, and the weight of uncertainty can become overwhelming.

Yet, through every trial—whether illness, confinement, loss, or seemingly insurmountable odds—we observe a common thread: the night prayer, Tahajjud, as a source of strength, guidance, and hope.

Tahajjud was not given to us as merely a ritual to check off or as an abstract act of worship. It was bestowed as a tool for the human heart—a

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way to bear life's burdens, find light in darkness, and connect with Allah during moments when all else seems lost. When Allah commanded His Messenger (peace be upon him) to pray, it was not just a spiritual duty. It was preparation for the greatest mission in human history: conveying the message of Islam in a hostile, resistant, and often dangerous world. The night prayer strengthened him, providing patience, focus, and strength to face opposition that might have crushed the resolve of any ordinary person.

The clearest example of this is the Battle of Badr. The odds were against the Muslims—vastly outnumbered, poorly equipped, and seemingly destined for defeat. Yet, the Prophet (peace be upon him) spent the night before the battle in prayer, pouring his heart out to Allah, seeking guidance, and praying for victory. This preparation was not wasted; it was a spiritual weapon, a way to align his heart with divine support. When the battle arrived, Allah sent angels to fight alongside them, a miraculous outcome that changed history. Without this support, Islam might have faced extinction.

This is not just history; it is a blueprint for our lives. Each of us has our own "Battle of Badr"—moments when the odds seem impossibly against us, when failure feels inevitable, and hope is hard to hold onto. It might be a failing marriage, a chronic illness, financial hardship, or the challenge of starting a family. It could be the fight against injustice, oppression, or even personal battles with anxiety, fear, and despair. The core principle remains the same: prepare, act, and trust in Allah. Tahajjud prepares us

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for these battles. It strengthens our hearts, sharpens our minds, and reminds us that the One who created the universe is aware of every detail of our lives.

Throughout this book, we have repeatedly seen how dua, combined with sincere effort, can be transformative. Dua alone is powerful, but its true strength is revealed when it is paired with action — such as studying, caring for family, seeking solutions, making ethical decisions, and persevering. Allah's response may not always be what we expect or arrive when we wish, but He is always at work. The stories you have read remind us that our role is effort and prayer, while the results are entirely in Allah's hands.

Tahajjud offers practical benefits beyond spirituality. It cultivates patience, humility, and consistency. It brings tranquillity when our hearts are overwhelmed and helps us focus on what genuinely matters. It reminds us that even in the darkest hours, we are never alone. In moments of despair, it becomes a direct link to Allah—a source of courage that no worldly power can rival.

Sadly, we live in a world where oppression, war, and injustice impact many lives. Muslims in some regions face genocide, conflict, and exile. Tahajjud and dua become not only personal lifelines but also tools of spiritual resilience. While we cannot control others' actions, we can take responsible steps—such as seeking help, offering support, raising awareness, or assisting those in need—while turning to Allah in prayer and

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reliance. Action and dua work together: we do what we can, and entrust the results to Allah, trusting in His justice and power.

As you reflect on the stories in this book, remember this: the battles may be real, the odds may seem insurmountable, and the weight may feel unbearable. But Tahajjud provides a way forward. It connects the human heart to the divine, transforms despair into hope, and prepares ordinary people for extraordinary challenges. Just as the Prophet (peace be upon him) prepared through night prayer before Badr, we too can prepare our hearts for the battles we face—knowing and believing that effort, sincerity, and reliance on Allah can move mountains.

So rise in the night. Speak to Allah with your heart open, lay bare your fears and hopes, then act. The battles of life will come and go, but Tahajjud will remain your source of strength, your anchor in uncertainty, and your direct connection to the One who controls all outcomes.

Let this book be a reminder: Your night prayers matter. Your dua matters. Your efforts matter. And Allah, in His infinite wisdom and mercy, sees every struggle and will guide you through your battles.

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Unlock the Hidden Power of Tahajjud

Tahajjud was one of the secret gems Allah bestowed upon Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) — a gift, a tool, and divine support for the most challenging mission in history. For a time, this prayer was nearly obligatory for him (peace be upon him) because the weight of his mission demanded more than human strength alone could provide. The Prophet (peace be upon him) faced unimaginable trials: losing his parents in childhood; the death of his children; the passing of Khadijah, his dear wife; the loss of his supportive uncle, Abu Talib; harassment by Quraysh; exile from his home; the cruelty of Ta'if; and the emotional toll of seeing loved ones perish or reject Islam. There were moments of despair, such as

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when the revelation paused, and he feared he had been abandoned. Surah Duha was revealed to comfort him during such darkness.

Yet he (peace be upon him) endured, not by human strength alone, but through a combination of tawakkul (trust in Allah), sabr (steadfast patience), daily dua and dhikr, prayers, and Tahajjud. It was one key piece of a holistic spiritual support system, fueling both resilience and action.

Why Tahajjud Matters for You

Tahajjud is more than a night prayer. It serves as a spiritual toolkit for anyone seeking strength, clarity, and purpose in life. It nurtures the ability to:

- Endure hardship: Life is filled with losses, setbacks, and challenges. Tahajjud reminds us that help is accessible and that perseverance pays off.
- Gain courage to take action: It is not passive. You pray, plan, and act—then leave the outcome to Allah.
- Elevate your character: Those who wake for night prayers cultivate patience, kindness, humility, and a sense of responsibility towards themselves and the community.

The Qur'an describes it clearly:

> And rise at (the last) part of the night, offering additional prayers, so your Lord may raise you to a station of praise.
>
> [Qur'an 17:79]

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Hidden Gems of Tahajjud

Tahajjud impacts more than just the individual. Historical examples demonstrate its power:

- Resilience in the face of injustice: Bilal (RA), abused and oppressed, discovered through Tahajjud the strength to pray for others rather than seek revenge.
- Moral refinement: Prolonged night prayers, humility, and worship shaped the Prophet (peace be upon him) and his companions into individuals capable of guiding nations.
- A keystone habit: Like exercise that kickstarts a healthier lifestyle, Tahajjud sets the tone for all other acts of worship, personal discipline, and social contribution.

Even in modern times, when exhaustion, stress, and constant demands weigh us down, Tahajjud can rejuvenate the spirit. It builds patience, inspires courage, and awakens insights that daytime routines alone cannot.

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Practical Steps to Unlock Its Power

You don't need to memorize long surahs or pray all night. Start small and let the habit grow:

- Sleep and wake: Take a short rest, then rise 20-30 minutes before Fajr. Even this small window is enough.
- Make wudu: Refresh yourself and prepare for your conversation with Allah.
- Pray 2 rakahs: Recite whichever surahs come naturally. For example, Surah Duha in the first rakah and Surah Ash-Sharh in the second work beautifully, but feel free to choose others.
- Make heartfelt dua: Speak to Allah about what matters to you—guidance, patience, courage, healing, or success in work and personal life. There's no formula; your words are enough.
- Focus on consistency, not length: One night can shift your mindset, but repeated nights build lasting strength. Small, steady steps create the greatest change.

Additional tips to thrive:

- Keep your sleep moderate and avoid overeating.
- Take short daytime naps if needed.
- Stay away from sin that might burden the heart.
- Begin with small, manageable steps and gradually increase dedication.

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Tahajjud and Action

The night prayer does not replace action; it enhances your efforts. You plan, work, and strive—yet you acknowledge that the outcome is in Allah's hands. Tahajjud sharpens the mind, strengthens resolve, and fuels the courage needed to act righteously, even when the odds seem insurmountable.

Your Personal Power

Imagine the energy of the Prophet (peace be upon him), the early companions, and the great scholars of Islam flowing through their nights of prayer—strength, resilience, and moral courage. Now imagine the same potential within you. Tahajjud can awaken it. It is not a magic formula, but a valuable, timeless tool for anyone willing to wake and pray.

Begin tonight with just two rakahs, and a commitment to try again tomorrow. With patience and consistency, the night prayer can become your source of energy, your secret superpower—equipping you to face life's challenges with the strength Allah grants to those who remember Him.

Tahajjud is the secret key that can unlock your potential, fuel your journey, and transform both your life and your contribution to the world.

So get up and pray.

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O you wrapped (in your clothes)!

Stand all night (in prayer) except a little—(pray) half the night, or a little less, or a little more—and recite the Quran (properly) in a measured way.

(For) We will soon send upon you a weighty revelation.

Indeed, worship in the night is more impactful and suitable for recitation.

For during the day you are over-occupied (with worldly duties).

(Always) remember the Name of your Lord, and devote yourself to Him wholeheartedly.

(He is the) Lord of the east and the west. There is no god (worthy of worship) except Him, so take Him (alone) as a Trustee of Affairs.

[Qur'an 73:1-9]

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A PERSONAL REQUEST

The Prophet was given a mission to change the world, and Allah granted him Tahajjud to find strength. We also need people to make a difference, now more than ever, and in this, Tahajjud becomes essential. For this reason, I want to spread this message across the Ummah. To every Muslim, every home, every corner of the world. But I cannot do this alone. I need your help.

Every person who starts praying Tahajjud because of this book is a source of Sadaqah Jariyah for you, for me, and for everyone who helped spread it.

Here is how you can help carry this message forward.

If you enjoyed this, consider grabbing the **full edition at PowerOfTahajjud.com**. It includes more real stories of people whose impossible duas were answered. Every purchase helps support the mission of spreading this message further.

Leave a review on **Amazon** or on **Goodreads** if Amazon is unavailable. It takes two minutes and helps this book reach people who need it.

Share it on social media and tag me. Find me on Instagram and TikTok at **@jawwad_ab**.

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